Lesson 3 — The Night the Network Failed

Part 6 of 12: Comprehension — TOEFL question types

Level: A2 (third step)

About 40 minutes · this part carries a sheet and audio

Part A — Multiple choice

1. (Factual) What was Omar studying?

   A. Design.
   B. Software engineering.
   C. Electricity.
   D. The passage does not say.

2. (Factual) What was Omar doing when the screen stopped moving?

   A. He was reading his email.
   B. He was uploading his files to the college server.
   C. He was restarting the browser.
   D. He was talking to the other students.

3. (Negative factual) According to the passage, Omar did all of the following EXCEPT

   A. check the cable.
   B. restart the browser.
   C. call his teacher.
   D. open his email.

4. (Vocabulary in context) The word "stuck" in the passage is closest in meaning to

   A. not moving.
   B. very fast.
   C. finished.
   D. broken into pieces.

5. (Reference) In the sentence, the file was there, but it was broken, the word "it" refers to

   A. the folder.
   B. the server.
   C. the file.
   D. the computer.

6. (Inference) It can be inferred from the passage that

   A. Omar sent the copy to himself because he was afraid of losing the file.

B. Omar lost three months of work.

C. power cuts were common in that building.

D. the other students lost their work too.

7. (Sentence insertion) Look at the four letters [A] [B] [C] [D] in the passage. Where would this sentence best fit?

> It was not the newest version, but it opened without a problem.

- A. At [A]
- B. At [B]
- C. At [C]
- D. At [D]

8. (Purpose of a paragraph — NEW) Why does the writer mention what Omar's teacher said in the first week?

A. To show that Omar was a careful student.

B. To explain how Omar found a second copy of his work.

C. To criticise the college for its electricity.

D. To show that the teacher was angry with Omar.

Part C — Fill in the blanks

Use these words. There are two extra words you will not need.

> server · stuck · broken · cable · version · save · per cent · careful · browser · project

1. Omar was finishing his final _____ at the computer centre.
2. He was uploading his files to the college _____.
3. The upload was _____ at sixty _____.
4. He checked the _____ and restarted the _____.
5. The file was there, but it was _____.
6. His teacher said: "_____ often, and save in two places."

Part D — Summary

Write the story in two sentences only. Use the past continuous once.

> Sentence 1 — what went wrong: _____ Sentence 2 — what saved his work: _____